class, which forms the focus of the next chapter, along with other view-related technology I have already touched on, including layouts, partials, and tag helpers.

2.2 Exploring the project files

Now that you have created your first Razor Pages application and experimented with a little Razor syntax, it is time to explore the contents of each folder and file that forms the web application you just created in more detail to learn about the role each plays in the application. Along the way, you will gain a clearer understanding of how ASP.NET Core applications work. You will also learn about the difference between the physical files on disk and what you see in the Solution Explorer window in Visual Studio.

2.2.1 The WebApplication1.sln file

The SLN file is known as a *solution* file. Within Visual Studio, solutions act as containers for managing related *project*s, and the solution file contains details of each project, including the paths to the project files. Visual Studio uses this information to load all related projects when you open the solution.

Larger web applications usually consist of multiple projects: a web application project responsible for the UI and multiple class library projects, each responsible for a logical layer within the application, such as the data access layer or the business logic layer. There may also be some unit test projects. Then you might see additional projects added with suffixes that denote their purpose: WebApplication1.Tests, WebApplication1.Data, and so on.